Asterial Team and Hiring Plan v4: John's one-pager

For Tue 10 Nov, 12:30, Pat's office. John only, not for circulation. Source: Shane's draft of 7 Nov. Figures are the plan's own; benchmarks not independently verified.

The plan in six lines

Round 1	20m to 22.5m euro at 100m to 125m valuation (about 18% to 20% given away)
Round 2	175m to 250m at 800m to 1.2bn, starting month 2 to 3, closing in 3 to 4 months
Team	18 (2 founders, 14 core hires, 2 interns); salaries 3.09m a year; hires start months 1 to 7
Year 1 spend	15.86m (70% of 22.5m); months 1 to 8: 10.86m
Held back	3.5m token and compute reserve; 3.14m unallocated buffer (14%) after year 1
Equity	Noesis 85%, Shane 5%, Diarmuid 10%, plus 12% option pool (hires at midpoints 10.4%)

Questions to put to Shane and Pat

- **Pool dilution.** Is the 12% pool carved from Noesis's 85% or shared pro rata? This is the one that decides how much of Noesis, and so of your position, is given up. Shane says it is his decision: ask him to decide before the investor sees the plan.
- **Bands against the pool.** The top of the hire bands adds to 12.1%, above the 12% pool. Is the pool 12%, or does it need to be 13% to 15%?
- **KEEP.** Does the share option scheme qualify inside the Noesis group? The plan says to confirm with Walter. Who is chasing him?
- **Structure.** The plan assumes Noesis 85 / Shane 5 / Diarmuid 10. Are the signed documents the same, including Diarmuid's 10% as non-voting Class B?
- **Investor lens.** Which lines will Vashid's side challenge? Likely: tokens at 146% of wages (4.52m), the 1m R&D line, 3.5m reserve plus 3.14m buffer, 150k founder salaries, about 3.3m across equipment, marketing and office lines.
- **Your decisions.** The plan says legal (450k), tax and accountancy (90k) and insurance (100k) are "to be priced by finance and John". Who is getting the quotes, and by when?
- **Negotiation channel.** Diarmuid is negotiating with Vashid (lawyer for the family) and also holds 10% of Asterial. What is John's role in the talks, and will you see terms before Shane signs anything?

Numbers to have in your head

Top salaries	CTO 320k; Orchestration Lead 260k; Head of Security 240k; Systems Architect 220k; Governance and Safety 210k
Top equity	CTO 2% to 3%; Orchestration Lead 1.5% to 2%; Head of Security, Systems Architect, Governance 0.75% to 1% each
Tokens	Shane 50k a month; Diarmuid 10k; architects 40k to 50k; builders 20k; Year 1 people tokens 3.91m
Year 2 run rate	8.01m for salaries, on-costs and people tokens, before company lines
Not sized	Racks, colocation and data-centre energy (needed if GPUs are bought rather than rented)

Arithmetic check by Cuan: salary sum, sign-on reserve (360k), eight-month and year-one totals, buffer and token ratio all reconcile. Nothing found wrong in the sums; the open points are decisions, not errors.

Notes